

GENDER

Kanvika Vishnoi Vs. Rajendra Rao



BENDERS

Make your own online matrimonial advertisement

Kanvika's mouse got into motion instantly when she was informed about making her own online matrimonial advertisement. She Googled up "matrimonial site" and got a long list of sites, and each result seemed to confuse

her. But soon she narrowed down her choice to shaadi.com, and hastily clicked "Join for free." When she hit the button to save her profile, she got a message: "Would you prefer a working wife?" The next moment she realised the goof-up, clicked back, and found that she'd



chosen her sex as male! The Gender Bender was officially over, and we told Kanvika she'd officially flunked!



When we told Rajendra what exactly he was supposed to do, he started off with pair of raised brows and a smirk on his face. Quite confidently, he took his browser to jeevansathi.com. Enthusiasm lit up his face, but he mistakenly chose "Yes, Not living together" under Children. And then he got stuck at the box where had to write

about himself. It seemed he hardly knew his own traits; he fumbled, but ended up writing too much about himself. Too long an ad for anyone to really read!



In November last year, Microsoft signed an agreement with Novell (SuSE Linux) to provide a mixed OS platform to those customers who requested it. So if you want a few servers or PCs running on an open source OS, Microsoft will recommend SuSE. The agreement also incorporates a clause that prevents Novell or Microsoft from suing each other for patent infringements.

Microsoft has also issued coupons that entitle their clients to support for SuSE Linux Enterprise Server, if they've chosen a mixed OS solution. Around

70,000 such coupons have been promised per year, and Microsoft claims to have already sold 35,000. How many have been used is another question altogether.

Popular opinion online seems to think that this little Linux-users-owe-us-money ploy has gone a little too far, and OSS fanatics have gone as far as labelling Novell as "sell-outs." Everyone seems to be asking, "Enough already, will Microsoft ever shut up and just tell the world what intellectual property Linux stole from them?", but no answers are forthcoming. Linux fans

also think Microsoft is deliberately not proving the patent infringements simply because there are none, and are just tomming it as a scare tactic to deter corporations from investing in Linux. It seems Novell did the smart thing by paying Microsoft to become the only Linux distribution that Ballmer cannot tch-tch at, and thus mop up all the revenues for non-Windows enterprise sales. In terms of the OSS end-user though, both Microsoft and Novell have fallen to new levels in terms of respect, and the hate grows. Ballmer may have put a pox on non-Novell Linux distros, but you can bet there are a few OSS fanatics practising voodoo on a little Ballmer doll somewhere... perhaps in a Red Hat office building!

GET IN THE GAME

Realism In A Couple Of Years

Have you seen the latest games? No, we're not talking about the weird ones with funky looking aliens and unbelievable worlds. We're talking about the games that try and immerse you in realism; the *Never Winter Nights 2* kind. Those of you who have seen videos and screenshots of the upcoming DX10 game *Crysis* will agree to the realism of the world that you will be plunged into

when you load the game. However, there's always one thing that betrays the virtual world; no, not the AI, it's the characters. Whether it's your own character, or the others that you have to interact with in games, they all look and act so unreal. Sure, we're well past the days of polygonal-shaped people, but we're still incapable of imagining game characters to be real humans. "Give us another year or two" seems to be the prediction of the gaming industry...

David Kunkler, one of the people behind *Never Winter Nights 2* said in an interview with BBC that motion capture technologies and graphics are improving rapidly. If all goes as planned, in a couple of years we will not be able to tell the difference between an actor in a movie and a game character. He also foresees this change as the advent of "emotional content in games."

Ian Livingstone from Eidos, the makers of the *Tomb Raider* series agrees: "We will be able to play with people's emotions—we can make them laugh, we can make them cry, we can make them sad."

So will this become the Third Life? We can certainly see some adult titles being released after they perfect the production of humans in games... whether game developers will ever get game characters to act naturally is another story altogether. We're still no closer to AI, and no matter how real

I'm A Mac!

Everyone seems to be talking about Apple's new "I'm a Mac" advertisements. For those of you who don't know, Apple released advertisements that portray PC users as uncool geeks and then compare them to Mac users, who they then portray as the "cool dudes." We, the media, are not letting an opportunity by to get the reactions of Microsoft higher-ups. Microsoft execs are a little more riled than they let on, which is clear from the comments they've made.

Bill Gates: "I don't think the over 90 per cent of those who use Windows PCs think of themselves as dullards, or the kind of klutzes that somebody is trying to say they are."

Steve Ballmer: "Remember, when you're the little tiny niche guy who owns about 2 per cent of the worldwide market, you can be cute one time and it helps you grow."

February, the month of not-so-good rejoinders...

Buzzword
of the MONTH